

Finite Verb

Definition

- Verbs that have a definite relation with the subject or noun.
- These verbs are usually the main verb of a clause or sentence and can be changed according to the noun.
- They are used only in present and past tense.
- They can be indicative of passive or active voice and also of number (singular or plural).

She **walks** home. – Here we see that the finite verb is “**walks**” and the pronoun is ‘she’.

She **walked** home. – Here we can see how the verb changed/modified to change the tense of the sentence.

Examples

- *You **promised** me the last ticket.*
- *I **am** excited about going to the [amusement](#) park.*
- *I **went** for a walk around the park.*
- *She **was waiting** in the room before he **came** in.*
- ***Does** your brother **know** my brother?*
- *We **want** John to act as club secretary.*
- *I **like** taking photographs of insects.*
- *Coming home last night, I **saw** a deer run across the road.*

Non-Finite Verbs

Non-finite verbs are a type of verb that do not show tense, mood, or gender. They cannot be the main verb of a sentence and do not indicate the action being performed by the subject or noun. Instead, non-finite verbs are used as nouns, adverbs, or adjectives.

Infinitives

Infinitives are non-finite verbs that are formed by adding “to” before the base form of the verb. They can be used as the subject, object, or complement in a sentence. Infinitives can also be used after certain verbs, such as “want,” “need,” and “like,” to express purpose.

Examples:

- To swim is my favorite activity.
- I want to learn how to play the guitar.

- She needs to finish her homework before going out.

Gerunds

Gerunds are non-finite verbs that end in “-ing” and function as nouns in a sentence. They can be used as the subject, object, or complement in a sentence. Gerunds can also be used after certain verbs, such as “enjoy,” “avoid,” and “admit,” to express an action.

Examples:

- Swimming is my favorite activity.
- I enjoy reading books.
- He admitted stealing the money.

Participles

Participles are non-finite verbs that can function as adjectives in a sentence. There are two types of participles: present participles and past participles. Present participles end in “-ing” and past participles end in “-ed,” “-d,” or “-t.”

Examples:

- The running water is so refreshing.
- The broken vase needs to be replaced.
- The excited children ran to the playground.